

Word family: **quarrel / quarrels / quarrelled / quarreled / quarrelling / quarreling / quarrelsome / quarreller / quarreler**

I'll keep the same full-family sweep: ordinary senses first, then constructions, figurative/formal uses, family members, distinctions, and finally the genuinely separate historical homonym.

Base word: quarrel

Plural: quarrels

British spelling:

* quarrelled

* quarrelling

American spelling:

* quarreled

* quarreling

Major related forms:

* quarrelsome

* quarrelsomely — uncommon

* quarrelsomeness — uncommon

* quarreller / quarreler — uncommon

Major constructions:

* quarrel with someone

* quarrel about something

* quarrel over something

* quarrel with an idea/claim

* have a quarrel

* have a quarrel with someone

* get into a quarrel

* pick a quarrel

* start a quarrel

* cause a quarrel

* settle a quarrel

* patch up a quarrel

* have no quarrel with

* someone's quarrel is with X

* lovers' quarrel

* family quarrel

* domestic quarrel

* quarrelsome person

Your passage:

> "...one bad month may force you to borrow money, **quarrel with your friends**, or close before your idea has had time to breathe."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **quarrel** is a verb meaning:

> **to have an angry disagreement, especially one involving personal tension or damage to a relationship.**

Kam Chai may open a café with friends. If money becomes tight, they may:

- * blame each other;
- * disagree about expenses;
- * argue about responsibilities;
- * become angry;
- * damage their friendship.

****繁體中文 : ****

* **爭吵**

* **吵架**

* **鬧矛盾**

* **發生口角**

So:

> "quarrel with your friends"

= **「與朋友爭吵 / 鬧矛盾」**

The word is stronger than simply:

> disagree

because **quarrel** normally carries:

> anger + personal tension.

A. QUARREL = AN ANGRY DISAGREEMENT

1. **a quarrel = angry disagreement between people (爭吵 ; 口角) **

This is the central noun sense.

> “They had a quarrel about money.”

「他們因金錢問題發生了**爭吵**。」

> “A small disagreement turned into a serious quarrel.”

「一場小小的意見分歧演變成嚴重的**爭吵**。」

A quarrel is usually primarily verbal, although it can precede or accompany more serious conflict. Dictionaries characterize it as an angry dispute and note that it can involve damage to friendly relations. ([字典網][1])

B. VERB: QUARREL = ARGUE ANGRILY

2. **quarrel = disagree angrily (爭吵 ; 吵架) **

> “The two friends quarrelled.”

「兩個朋友**吵架了**。」

This is normally **intransitive**.

You do not usually say:

> *quarrel someone* ❌

Use:

> quarrel **with** someone.

C. QUARREL WITH SOMEONE

3. **quarrel with someone = 與某人吵架**

This is your exact construction.

> “Don't quarrel with your business partner over every small decision.”

「不要因每個小決定都跟你的生意伙伴**爭吵**。」

D. QUARREL ABOUT SOMETHING

4. **quarrel about X = 為 X 爭吵**

> “They quarrelled about who should pay.”

「他們為誰應該付款而**吵架**。」

About introduces the subject of disagreement.

E. QUARREL OVER SOMETHING

5. **quarrel over X = 因 X 而爭執**

> “The partners quarrelled over money.”

「幾名合夥人因金錢問題而**爭吵**。」

Over very often emphasizes:

> the matter causing the conflict.

Common:

- * quarrel over money
- * quarrel over property
- * quarrel over responsibilities
- * quarrel over small things

F. QUARREL ABOUT vs QUARREL OVER

The difference is small.

quarrel about X

focuses on:

> topic being argued about.

quarrel over X

often emphasizes:

> X as the cause/stake in the conflict.

Compare:

> quarrel about politics

> quarrel over an inheritance.

Large overlap exists.

G. HAVE A QUARREL

6. **have a quarrel = have an angry argument (吵一架) **

> “We had a quarrel yesterday.”

「我們昨天**吵了一架**。」

Very common noun construction.

H. HAVE A QUARREL WITH SOMEONE

7. **have a quarrel with someone = 跟某人爭吵**

> “She had a quarrel with her colleague.”

「她和同事**吵了一架**。」

I. GET INTO A QUARREL

8. **get into a quarrel = 捲入 / 開始一場爭吵**

> “He got into a quarrel with another customer.”

「他跟另一名顧客**吵了起來**。」

Often suggests:

> situation escalated into an argument.

J. START A QUARREL

9. **start a quarrel = 挑起 / 開始爭吵**

> “Don't start a quarrel over something so minor.”

「不要為這麼小的事情**挑起爭吵**。」

K. PICK A QUARREL

10. **pick a quarrel with someone = deliberately provoke an argument (故意找碴吵架) **

A very important fixed expression.

> “He seemed determined to pick a quarrel with everyone.”

「他好像故意要跟每個人**找碴吵架**。」

This is stronger than:

> have a quarrel.

It implies:

> deliberately looking for a reason to fight verbally.

L. PICK A FIGHT vs PICK A QUARREL

pick a quarrel

provoke an angry verbal disagreement.

pick a fight

can mean:

- * provoke an argument;
- * provoke a physical fight.

****Fight**** is broader and potentially more physical.

M. CAUSE A QUARREL

11. **cause a quarrel = 引起爭吵**

> “Money problems caused repeated quarrels.”

「金錢問題引起多次****爭吵****。」

N. LEAD TO A QUARREL

12. **lead to a quarrel = 導致爭吵**

Directly relevant to your passage:

- > insufficient cash
- > → stress
- > → disagreement
- > → quarrel.

O. BREAK OUT — QUARREL

13. **a quarrel breaks out = 爭吵突然爆發**

> “A quarrel broke out between the two owners.”

「兩名店主之間突然****爆發爭吵****。」

More dramatic.

P. SERIOUS / BITTER / VIOLENT QUARREL

14. **serious quarrel = 嚴重爭吵**

15. **bitter quarrel = 激烈而帶怨恨的爭執**

> “A bitter quarrel divided the family.”

「一場激烈而充滿怨氣的爭執令家庭分裂。」

16. **violent quarrel = 激烈爭執**

Can mean highly heated and potentially physically aggressive, depending on context.

Do not automatically interpret:

> violent quarrel

as proven physical assault without further context.

Q. PETTY / TRIVIAL QUARREL

17. **petty quarrel = 為小事而起的爭吵**

> “They kept having petty quarrels.”

「他們經常為小事**爭吵**。」

R. FAMILY QUARREL

18. **family quarrel = 家庭爭執**

Can involve:

- * money;
- * inheritance;
- * relationships;
- * responsibilities.

S. DOMESTIC QUARREL

19. **domestic quarrel = 家庭 / 伴侶間爭吵**

Usually refers to a disagreement within:

- * couple;
- * household;
- * family.

Important:

> **domestic quarrel does not automatically mean domestic violence.**

It may be verbal only.

T. LOVERS' QUARREL

20. **lovers' quarrel = 情侶間的爭吵**

> "It began as a lovers' quarrel."

「事情最初只是情侶之間的一場**爭吵**。」

Usually suggests conflict within a romantic relationship.

U. MARITAL QUARREL

21. **marital quarrel = 婚姻中的爭執**

Formal.

V. BUSINESS / PARTNERSHIP QUARREL

22. **business quarrel = 商業糾紛 / 合作伙伴爭執**

Not as lexicalized as other compounds, but common compositionally.

For your passage:

> quarrels among co-founders/partners can arise over:

* money;
* workload;
* equity;
* decisions;
* strategy.

W. QUARREL BETWEEN PEOPLE/GROUPS

23. **a quarrel between A and B**

> “There was a quarrel between the two partners.”

「兩名合夥人之間發生了**爭執**。」

X. QUARREL AMONG A GROUP

24. **quarrels among members = 成員之間的爭執**

> “Internal quarrels weakened the organization.”

「內部爭執削弱了該組織。」

Y. QUARREL = BREAK IN RELATIONSHIP

25. **quarrel = disagreement severe enough to damage friendly relations (鬧翻；反目) **

Older/general dictionary definitions include the idea that a quarrel can lead to a temporary or permanent break in friendship. ([字典網][1])

> “They quarrelled and stopped speaking for years.”

「他們鬧翻後多年沒有再說話。」

This is stronger than merely:

> debate.

Z. QUARREL AND MAKE UP

26. **quarrel and make up = 吵架後和好**

> “They quarrel often, but they always make up.”

「他們經常吵架，但總會**和好**。」

AA. SETTLE A QUARREL

27. **settle a quarrel = 解決爭端 / 平息爭吵**

> “They finally settled their quarrel.”

「他們終於**解決了爭端**。」

Can mean:

> resolve the disagreement.

AB. PATCH UP A QUARREL

28. **patch up a quarrel = 修補關係、和解**

More idiomatically, English often says:

> patch things up after a quarrel

or:

> patch up their differences.

Still, **patch up a quarrel** is understandable and established enough in older/formal usage.

AC. END A QUARREL

29. **end a quarrel = 結束爭吵**

Neutral.

AD. MEDIATE A QUARREL

30. **mediate a quarrel/dispute = 調解爭端**

More formal.

AE. OLD QUARREL

31. **an old quarrel = 積怨已久的爭端**

> “The argument reopened an old quarrel.”

「這場爭論重新挑起了多年來的**舊怨 / 舊爭端**。」

Here **quarrel** may refer to a long-standing dispute rather than one single episode of shouting.

AF. PRIVATE QUARREL

32. **private quarrel = 私人恩怨 / 私人爭執**

> “I don't want to become involved in their private quarrel.”

「我不想介入他們的**私人恩怨**。」

AG. PERSONAL QUARREL

33. **personal quarrel = 私人爭執 / 個人恩怨**

Contrasts with:

* professional disagreement;

* ideological dispute.

AH. QUARREL = CAUSE / GROUND OF COMPLAINT

This is an important second noun branch.

34. **quarrel = cause for complaint, objection, or disagreement (不滿 ; 爭議所在) **

Dictionaries explicitly record **quarrel** as the cause of a dispute or complaint, not only the argument itself. ([字典網][1])

This survives especially in:

> **have no quarrel with X**

AI. HAVE NO QUARREL WITH

35. **have no quarrel with X = have no objection to / complaint about X (對 X 沒有異議 / 不滿) **

A very important formal idiom.

> “I have no quarrel with the basic idea.”

「我對這個基本想法**沒有異議**。」

It does **not** mean:

> “I have not shouted at the idea.”

Instead:

> I do not object to it.

AJ. HAVE A QUARREL WITH AN IDEA / POLICY / CLAIM

36. **have a quarrel with X = object to X (對 X 有異議) — formal**

> “My quarrel is not with the goal but with the method.”

「我不滿的並不是目標，而是方法。」

Very useful argumentative construction.

AK. **MY QUARREL IS WITH X**

37. **my quarrel is with X = my objection/complaint concerns X**

> “My quarrel is with the pricing system, not the staff.”

「我有意見的是**定價制度**，不是員工。」

Here **quarrel** = objection/grievance.

No actual interpersonal argument is required.

AL. **THE ONLY QUARREL I HAVE WITH X**

38. **the only quarrel I have with X = the only objection/problem I have with X**

> “The only quarrel I have with the proposal is its cost.”

「我對這個方案唯一的**異議**是成本。」

Formal/literary.

AM. VERB: QUARREL WITH AN IDEA / CLAIM

39. **quarrel with X = object to, dispute, find fault with X (反對 ; 質疑) — formal**

> “Few people would quarrel with that conclusion.”

「很少人會**反對 / 質疑**這個結論。」

This is an important figurative verb sense.

No anger is necessary.

AN. **WHO COULD QUARREL WITH THAT?**

40. **Who could quarrel with that? = 誰會反對呢? **

Rhetorical:

> the statement seems difficult to object to.

AO. **I CAN'T QUARREL WITH THAT**

41. **I can't quarrel with that = 我對此沒有異議**

Formal/slightly old-fashioned.

Means:

> it seems reasonable/acceptable.

AP. QUARREL WITH FACTS

42. **quarrel with facts/evidence = dispute or reject them**

> “You cannot quarrel with the figures.”

Approximately:

「這些數字是**難以反駁的**。」

Formal rhetorical use.

AQ. QUARREL WITH A WORD / TERM / DEFINITION

43. **quarrel with wording/terminology = object to it**

> “I would quarrel with his use of the word ‘failure’.”

「我會對他使用『失敗』這個詞**提出異議**。」

Academic/formal.

AR. QUARREL WITH ONE'S FATE / CIRCUMSTANCES — LITERARY

44. **quarrel with fate / one's circumstances = resent or protest against them**

Literary.

> “He had learned not to quarrel with fate.”

「他已學會不再**怨懟命運**。」

Low priority.

AS. QUARREL = COMPLAIN / FIND FAULT — OLDER/FORMAL

45. **quarrel = complain or find fault (抱怨；挑剔) — older/formal**

Dictionaries still preserve this verb branch. ([字典網][1])

Example:

> “I do not quarrel with your choice.”

= 「我對你的選擇沒有意見。」

This overlaps strongly with:

> object to / take issue with.

AT. QUARRELSOME

46. **quarrelsome = frequently inclined to quarrel (愛爭吵的；好鬥嘴的) **

> “He becomes quarrelsome when tired.”

「他疲倦時會變得很**愛吵架**。」

The adjective describes a tendency/personality/temporary disposition.

AU. QUARRELSOME PERSON

47. **quarrelsome person = 愛與人爭執的人**

Often negative:

* argumentative;

* irritable;
* confrontational.

AV. QUARRELSOME MOOD

48. **quarrelsome mood = 想找人吵架的情緒**

> “She was in a quarrelsome mood.”

「她當時情緒很差，**動不動就想跟人爭吵**。」

AW. QUARRELSOME RELATIONSHIP

49. **quarrelsome relationship = 爭吵頻繁的關係**

Less common, but natural.

AX. QUARRELSOMELY

50. **quarrelsomely = in an argumentative/combative manner (好爭吵地) **

Rare.

Normally English prefers:

> argumentatively

> in a quarrelsome way.

AY. QUARRELSOMENESS

51. **quarrelsomeness = tendency to quarrel (好爭吵的性情) **

Rare but genuine.

AZ. QUARRELLER / QUARRELER

52. **quarreller / quarreler = person who quarrels (爭吵者) **

A valid derivative, but uncommon. Dictionaries list both British and American spellings. ([柯林斯詞典][2])

Normally say:

> argumentative person

> quarrelsome person.

BA. QUARRELLING / QUARRELING — NOUN-LIKE USE

53. **quarrelling = the activity of repeatedly arguing (爭吵) **

> “Their constant quarrelling exhausted everyone.”

「他們不停**爭吵**，令所有人都很疲累。」

This is a gerund rather than a wholly separate lexical noun.

BB. QUARRELLING COUPLE / PARTNERS

54. **quarrelling + noun = 正在 / 經常爭吵的**

> “The quarrelling partners could no longer run the company together.”

「那幾名經常爭吵的合夥人已無法再一起經營公司。」

BC. QUARREL VS ARGUE

This is the most important learner distinction.

argue

can simply mean:

> exchange opposing reasons/views.

It can be:

- * calm;
- * academic;
- * logical;
- * angry.

quarrel

normally implies:

> interpersonal anger or friction.

Compare:

> “The scholars argued about the interpretation.”

could be professional debate.

> “The scholars quarrelled about it.”

suggests personal hostility/tension.

BD. QUARREL VS DISAGREE

disagree

simply hold different views.

quarrel

express those differences angrily.

You can disagree completely without quarrelling.

BE. QUARREL VS DISPUTE

dispute

can be:

- * formal;
- * legal;
- * commercial;

* factual.

quarrel

usually more personal/emotional.

> contractual dispute

> family quarrel.

BF. QUARREL VS CONFLICT

conflict

very broad incompatibility/struggle.

Can occur between:

* countries;

* interests;

* duties;

* systems.

quarrel

usually specific interpersonal/group disagreement.

BG. QUARREL VS FIGHT

fight

can be:

* physical;

* verbal;

* military;

* competitive.

quarrel

usually verbal disagreement.

So:

> they quarrelled

does not automatically mean:

> they hit each other.

BH. QUARREL VS ARGUMENT

argument

can mean:

1. angry disagreement;
2. reasoned case.

quarrel

normally only the interpersonal-conflict type.

So:

> “His argument is convincing.”

cannot be replaced with:

> *His quarrel is convincing.*

BI. QUARREL VS BICKER

bicker

repeated petty arguing, often over small things.

quarrel

can be minor or very serious.

> children bicker

> business partners may have a major quarrel.

BJ. QUARREL VS SQUABBLE

squabble

petty, noisy, undignified quarrel.

quarrel

neutral broader word for angry disagreement.

Dictionary synonym notes distinguish **squabble** as especially petty and **wrangle** as noisy/insistent. ([柯林斯詞典][3])

BK. QUARREL VS WRANGLE

wrangle

long/noisy argument in which people insist strongly on positions.

quarrel

more general and personal.

> wrangle over contract terms

> quarrel with a friend.

BL. QUARREL VS ALTERCATION

altercation

formal word for a heated confrontation.

quarrel

ordinary word.

An altercation sounds:

> sharper, more dramatic, possibly bordering on physical confrontation.

BM. QUARREL VS SPAT

spat

informal, usually minor and short quarrel.

quarrel

may be much more serious and lasting.

> “They had a little spat.”

sounds lighter than:

> “They had a bitter quarrel.”

BN. QUARREL VS ROW

row — especially BrE

an angry noisy argument.

quarrel

similar but less specifically noisy.

In British English:

> “They had a row.”

is very common.

BO. QUARREL VS FEUD

quarrel

one disagreement or dispute.

feud

long-running hostility involving repeated conflict.

A quarrel may:

> start a feud.

BP. QUARREL VS FALLING-OUT

falling-out

break/deterioration in a personal relationship caused by disagreement.

quarrel

the argument itself.

> They had a quarrel and then a falling-out.

BQ. QUARREL VS GRIEVANCE

grievance

reason for feeling wronged.

quarrel

can mean the dispute itself **or**, formally, the ground of complaint.

This explains:

> "I have no quarrel with X."

BR. QUARREL VS OBJECTION

objection

specific reason for opposing something.

quarrel

in formal constructions can mean broader objection/complaint.

> “My only objection...”

> “My only quarrel...”

The latter is more literary/formal.

BS. QUARREL VS COMPLAINT

complaint

statement/reason that something is wrong or unsatisfactory.

quarrel

may grow out of a complaint, but ordinarily implies disagreement with another party.

BT. QUARREL VS DEBATE

debate

structured discussion of opposing views.

quarrel

angry personal disagreement.

An academic debate ideally does not become a quarrel.

BU. QUARREL VS CONTROVERSY

controversy

broad public disagreement surrounding an issue.

quarrel

usually interpersonal/group dispute.

A controversy can lead to many separate quarrels.

BV. QUARREL VS CLASH

clash

sharp conflict between:

- * personalities;
- * ideas;
- * groups.

quarrel

often one specific angry interaction.

- > personality clash
- > quarrel over money.

BW. QUARREL VS CONFRONTATION

confrontation

direct hostile encounter.

quarrel

specifically centers on verbal disagreement.

BX. QUARREL VS DIFFERENCE

Older/formal:

- > "They had a difference."

can mean disagreement.

But:

- > **quarrel**

signals more anger.

BY. FRIENDS QUARREL / FRIENDSHIP DAMAGE

Your passage deliberately uses **quarrel** rather than simply **disagree**.

Why?

Because starting a café with friends creates **dual relationships**:

> friendship + business partnership.

A disagreement about:

- * cash;
- * working hours;
- * ownership;
- * duties

can therefore become personally emotional.

So:

> disagreement threatens a decision.

but:

> quarrel threatens the **friendship**.

BZ. MONEY AS A SOURCE OF QUARRELS

55. **quarrel over money**

A highly natural collocation.

> “Couples often quarrel over money.”

「伴侶之間可能因金錢問題而爭吵。」

In your passage:

> financial pressure can turn commercial disagreements into personal quarrels.

CA. QUARREL OVER RESPONSIBILITY

56. **quarrel over who should do/pay/decide X**

Very common.

> “They quarrelled over who should work weekends.”

「他們為誰應該週末上班而**爭吵**。」

CB. QUARREL OVER OWNERSHIP / SHARES

57. **quarrel over ownership/equity**

Business-partnership context:

> fight about who owns what/how much.

CC. QUARREL OVER SMALL THINGS

58. **quarrel over/about trivial matters**

> “Stress made them quarrel over tiny things.”

「壓力令他們連小事也會**爭吵**。」

CD. FIXED CONSTRUCTION: **NO QUARREL WITH**

59. **I have no quarrel with X**

This is sufficiently distinct to memorize separately.

It means:

> **I accept X / I do not object to X.**

Examples:

> “I have no quarrel with his conclusion.”

「我對他的結論沒有異議。」

> “I have no quarrel with people who choose differently.”

「對於作出不同選擇的人，我沒有意見。」

CE. **QUARREL IS WITH... NOT...**

60. **My quarrel is with X, not Y**

A useful argumentative frame.

> “My quarrel is with the implementation, not the principle.”

「我不滿的是執行方式，而不是原則本身。」

This is often translated better as:

* **異議**

* **不滿**

* **爭議所在**

rather than literal 「爭吵」.

CF. NEGATIVE POLARITY: **HARD TO QUARREL WITH**

61. **hard/difficult to quarrel with = hard to object to**

> “That is a conclusion difficult to quarrel with.”

「這是一個**很難反駁的結論**。」

Formal.

CG. “QUARREL WITH SUCCESS”?

62. **one cannot quarrel with success/results**

Rhetorical construction:

> if the outcome is clearly good, it is difficult to object.

Formal/idiomatic, lower priority.

CH. SPELLING

British/Hong Kong-oriented English generally prefers:

* **quarrelled**

* **quarrelling**

American English normally prefers:

* **quarreled**

* **quarreling**

Both sets are standard. Dictionaries explicitly record this regional variation. ([柯林斯詞典][4])

CI. GRAMMAR

63. **quarrel with + person**

> quarrel with a friend.

64. **quarrel about + subject**

> quarrel about money.

65. **quarrel over + source/stake**

> quarrel over ownership.

66. **quarrel with + proposition/idea**

Formal:

> quarrel with a conclusion.

= object to it.

67. **a quarrel with + person**

> “a quarrel with his brother”

68. **a quarrel about/over + issue**

> a quarrel about money

> a quarrel over property.

69. **a quarrel between + parties**

> a quarrel between neighbours.

70. **quarrel among + several people**

> quarrels among partners.

CJ. TRANSITIVITY

Modern everyday **quarrel** is overwhelmingly **intransitive**:

> They quarrelled.

> They quarrelled with each other.

Not:

> *They quarrelled the issue.* ❌

For formal objection:

> quarrel with the issue/claim

still uses ****with****.

CK. COUNTABILITY

****quarrel = argument****

Countable:

> a quarrel

> several quarrels.

****quarrel = grievance/objection****

Usually occurs in fixed countable constructions:

> my quarrel with X

> no quarrel with X.

****quarrelling = activity****

Usually uncountable gerund:

> constant quarrelling.

CL. COMPLETELY SEPARATE HISTORICAL HOMONYM

There is another ****quarrel**** with a different historical origin from the “argument” word.

The conflict word ultimately comes through Latin ****querela****, “complaint,” while the following old noun comes from a root meaning ****square****. Dictionaries therefore treat them as separate homonyms. ([字典網][1])

CM. QUARREL = CROSSBOW BOLT

71. **quarrel = square/four-edged-headed bolt fired from a crossbow (方頭弩箭) — historical**

A **quarrel** was a crossbow bolt or arrow with a square/quadrangular head. This is now mainly encountered in historical writing, archaeology, medieval weaponry, fantasy literature, or dictionaries. ([字典網][1])

****繁體中文 : ****

*** **方頭弩箭****

*** **四稜弩箭****

This has absolutely no semantic connection in modern English to:

> two people quarrelling.

CN. QUARREL = SMALL PANE OF GLASS

72. **quarrel = small square or diamond-shaped pane of glass (方形 / 菱形小玻璃窗格) — historical/architectural**

Especially:

> one of many small panes set in lead in a lattice/casement window.

This sense is still documented in dictionaries but is now specialist/rare. ([字典網][1])

****繁體中文 : ****

*** **方形小玻璃窗格****

*** **菱形玻璃窗格****

CO. QUARREL = PYRAMID-HEADED TOOL — VERY RARE

73. **quarrel = certain tool with pyramidal head — historical/specialist**

Some dictionaries preserve this technical sense as an extension of the separate “square-shaped object” homonym. ([字典網][1])

****Priority:** extremely low.**

CP. DO NOT MERGE THE TWO “QUARRELS”

For database architecture, I would treat:

QUARREL¹

argument / complaint / objection

and

QUARREL²

crossbow bolt / square or diamond pane

as **separate homonymous lexical branches**, not as figurative extensions of one core meaning.

Their etymologies and concepts are unrelated. ([字典網][1])

CQ. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning	
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quarrel — noun dispute	angry interpersonal disagreement	
quarrel — verb	argue angrily	
quarrel — relationship rupture	fall out because of disagreement	
quarrel — grievance	cause for complaint/objection	
quarrel with an idea	formally object to/dispute it	
have no quarrel with	have no objection/complaint	
quarrelsome	inclined to argue/fight verbally	
quarrelling	repeated/current arguing	
quarreller	person who quarrels; uncommon	
quarrel ² — bolt	historical square/four-edged crossbow bolt	
quarrel ² — glass	small square/diamond window pane	
quarrel ² — tool	rare pyramidal-headed tool	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
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quarrel — noun	帶有怒氣及人際衝突的一場爭吵 / 口角	
quarrel — verb	因意見、金錢等問題與人憤怒地爭吵	
quarrel with someone	跟某人吵架	
quarrel about something	就某個話題爭吵	

quarrel over something	因某個利益 / 問題而爭執	
have a quarrel	發生一場爭吵	
get into a quarrel	與某人爭吵起來 / 捲入爭執	
start a quarrel	引起 / 開始一場爭吵	
pick a quarrel	故意找理由挑起爭吵	
bitter quarrel	帶着強烈怨恨的激烈爭執	
petty quarrel	因小事引起的爭吵	
family/domestic quarrel	家庭 / 伴侶之間的爭吵	
lovers' quarrel	情侶之間的爭吵	
settle a quarrel	解決雙方的爭端	
old quarrel	持續已久的舊怨 / 爭端	
personal/private quarrel	個人 / 私人恩怨	
quarrel — damaged friendship	因憤怒爭執而鬧翻、損害關係	
have no quarrel with X	對 X 沒有不滿 / 異議	
my quarrel is with X	我真正不滿 / 反對的是 X	
quarrel with an idea/claim	正式：對某看法 / 主張提出異議或反駁	
cannot quarrel with X	正式：很難反對 / 否認 X	
quarrel — complain/find fault	較舊 / 正式：抱怨、挑剔、提出異議	
quarrelsome	經常喜歡與別人爭吵的	
quarrelsome mood	容易動怒、想與人爭執的情緒	
quarrelling	持續 / 反覆爭吵這種行為	
quarreller/quarreler	爭吵者；較少用	
quarrel ² — crossbow	歷史：帶方形 / 四稜箭頭的弩箭	
quarrel ² — window pane	歷史 / 建築：方形或菱形的小玻璃窗格	
quarrel ² — tool	極罕見：某些帶金字塔狀頭部的工具	

For your original passage

> “...one bad month may force you to borrow money, **quarrel with your friends**, or close before your idea has had time to breathe.”

The precise meaning is:

> **financial pressure could create angry personal disagreements between Kam Chai and the friends with whom he starts the café.**

The author deliberately chooses **quarrel**, not merely:

> disagree.

Because if three friends disagree about:

- * who works longer hours;
- * who contributes more capital;
- * whether to borrow;
- * whether to cut costs;

* whether one person is doing enough;

the disagreement can spill from:

> **business decision**

into:

> **friendship conflict**.

So the sentence is warning about **relationship risk**, not only financial risk.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering would be:

> **「如果沒有足夠的財務安全墊，只要遇上一個月生意不佳，你便可能被迫借錢、與朋友爭吵，甚至在構想尚未有時間成熟之前便關店。」**

For the core database, I would keep **4 principal semantic branches** under the normal **quarrel¹** family:

1. **noun: angry interpersonal disagreement**
2. **verb: argue angrily, sometimes damaging the relationship**
3. **formal noun: grievance/cause for objection — “my quarrel is with...”**
4. **formal verb: object to/dispute something — “I can't quarrel with that”**

Then separately index **quarrelsome, pick a quarrel, have no quarrel with, lovers' quarrel** , and keep the historical **quarrel² = crossbow bolt / small square or diamond pane** as a completely separate homonym rather than forcing it into the disagreement meaning.

[1]: https://www.dictionary.com/browse/quarrel?utm_source=chatgpt.com "QUARREL Definition & Meaning | Dictionary.com"

[2]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/hi/dictionary/english/quarrel?utm_source=chatgpt.com "QUARREL परिभाषा और अर्थ | कोलिन्स अंग्रेज़ी शब्दकोश"

[3]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/us/dictionary/english/quarrel?utm_source=chatgpt.com "QUARREL definition in American English | Collins English Dictionary"

[4]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/dictionary/english/quarrel?utm_source=chatgpt.com "QUARREL definition and meaning | Collins English Dictionary"